

One-year MBA programmes are becoming increasingly popular in India, and the main reason for this is the demand from working professionals

AI and ML in a certain sector, say, manufacturing. But I need to know a little bit of manufacturing as well. So, I need marketing, finance, organisational behaviour and all these core concepts to be put in perspective.” The consensus among India’s top MBA institutes is that the two-year courses will persist at least for the next decade. But the opportunity cost involved in staying away from the workforce for two years in a fast-changing business world for professionals with work experience is fuelling the interest for one-year programmes. “Experienced professionals are the driving force behind the rapid adoption of the one-year MBA programme in India,” says Fr George.

Institutes such as Indian School of Business (ISB), IIMs A-

B-C, XLRI, and SPJIMR, among others, have started the one-year format, reflecting the industry’s demand for practical experience combined with specialised business education. ISB, the pioneer of the one-year format in India, sees work experience as important for MBAs. “It leads to better learning outcomes because of students’ ability to connect what is taught in the classroom with what they had experienced previously. They get better context and learning from the lectures because of this relatability,” says Ramabhadran Thirumalai, Deputy Dean-Academic Programmes, ISB.

Not surprisingly, experts predict greater pull for the one-year format in times to come. “I won’t be surprised in the long run if things shift more and more to a

one-year programme, particularly for people with experience,” says IIMB’s Krishnan.

Client expectations from the consulting industry are evolving, which reflects in the hiring profiles, says Priya Ramdev, Director of People Function at McKinsey & Company. “While the generalist consulting aptitude remains integral to client needs, industry/functional knowledge and expertise is also becoming critical for certain roles. Any programme that can meet these requirements will continue to remain relevant for the industry,” she says.

While the pandemic’s soothsayers predicted that management education would go fully online, the verdict three years since is that a fully online programme cannot offer the whole breadth of experiences that an on-campus programme can—peer-to-peer learning and networking being chief among them. And so, with both formats likely to continue, many institutes have retained some degree of online learning as they plug the crucial gaps of reach, affordability and scale in traditional methods.

US-BASED ONLINE learning platform Coursera says it now has 17 Indian university partners, including top B-schools such as IIM Ahmedabad (IIMA) and IIMC. Three years ago, it had just two. For instance, SPJIMR’s online

TOP OF THE CHARTS

Top 5 institutes offering two-year MBA programmes in India

Rank (2023)	Rank (2022)	Institute	Overall Score (1,000)
1	1	Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Calcutta	899.9
2	2	Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Ahmedabad	897.1
3	3	Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Bangalore	892.3
4	4	Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Lucknow	861.8
5	5	S.P. Jain Institute of Management & Research (SPJIMR), Mumbai	856.6

SOURCE BT-MDRA SURVEY